

About Me

Research scientist and engineer with 4+ years of experience in recommender systems, with accepted papers at KDD, SIGIR, and RecSys. Currently a Senior Research Scientist at AI VK. B.Sc. from Lomonosov Moscow State University; M.Sc. candidate at the Higher School of Economics.

Research Interests

Information retrieval, conversational recommendation, large language models, generative recommendation, in-text reasoning for recommendation, reinforcement learning, and the mathematical foundations of deep learning.

Work Experience

Mar 2026 – Present **Senior Research Scientist, AI VK**

Research team led by [Prof. Dr. Alexander D'yakonov](#), formerly world's #1 rank on Kaggle.

- Worked on long-term RL optimization for generative retrieval in recommender systems; first author of *Long-Term Optimization for Large-Scale Generative Retrieval with Off-Policy REINFORCE* (KDD 2026).
- Made major contributions to the internal research framework, speeding up experiment iteration several-fold.

Jul 2025 – Mar 2026 **RecSys R&D Team Lead / Senior Research Engineer, Yandex**

- Led a three-person R&D team responsible for pretraining generative recommendation models, internal training framework development, and inference optimization.
- Worked on pretraining a OneRec-style generative recommender that replaces the entire cascade pipeline (candidate generation, ranking, and re-ranking) with a single end-to-end neural network.
- Introduced FSDP (Fully Sharded Data Parallel) training, scaling recommender transformers up to 7 billion parameters with improved model quality.
- Built the training framework and infrastructure for large-scale generative recommender models.
- Worked on adapting sub-quadratic attention mechanisms for generative retrieval in recommender systems ([paper](#)).

May 2023 – Jul 2025 **RecSys Research Engineer, Yandex**

- Investigated graph neural networks for item representation in recommender systems ([talk](#)).
- Developed a transformer-based candidate generation model for Yandex Market and conducted A/B tests.
- Co-developed [Argus](#), a billion-parameter generative recommender transformer; achieved +2.26% Total Listening Time and +6.37% item like rate at Yandex Music in online A/B tests; later adapted across Yandex products (e.g., e-commerce +1.7% GMV, food-tech +2.1% GMV).
- Contributed to Argus adaptation for Yandex Ads ranking, delivering +2% revenue uplift in online A/B tests ([talk](#)).
- Mentored two interns, who have since become a Senior RecSys Researcher and a core developer at YandexGPT.

Feb 2022 – Jul 2022 **Backend Developer Intern, Yandex**

- C++ backend development: optimized runtime performance of search algorithms and data-preparation pipelines.
- Implemented new ML features and conducted A/B tests.

Education

Sep 2024 – Present **Higher School of Economics (HSE)**, Moscow, Russia

Master's Program in Modern Computer Science.

Thesis: *Long-Term Optimization for Large-Scale Generative Retrieval*.

Sep 2024 – Present **Yandex School of Data Analysis (YSDA)**, Moscow, Russia

Selective postgraduate program in machine learning, deep learning, and applied mathematics.

Sep 2020 – Jun 2024 **Lomonosov Moscow State University (MSU)**, Faculty of CMC, Moscow, Russia

B.Sc. in Applied Mathematics and Computer Science.

Thesis: *Graph Neural Networks for Candidate Retrieval in E-Commerce*.

— Selected Publications

KDD 2026	Long-Term Optimization for Large-Scale Generative Retrieval with Off-Policy REINFORCE, <i>5th Workshop on End-to-End Customer Journey Optimization</i> Artem Matveev , Sergei Makeev, Aleksei Krasilnikov, Vladimir Baikalov, Sergei Liamaev, Kirill Khrylchenko Scaling Recommender Transformers to One Billion Parameters Kirill Khrylchenko, Artem Matveev , Sergei Makeev, Vladimir Baikalov
SIGIR 2026	Gated Bidirectional Linear Attention for Generative Retrieval Artem Matveev , Vladislav Tytskiy, Sergei Makeev, Sergei Liamaev
RecSys 2025	Correcting the LogQ Correction: Revisiting Sampled Softmax for Large-Scale Retrieval Kirill Khrylchenko, Vladimir Baikalov, Sergei Makeev, Artem Matveev , Sergei Liamaev
arXiv preprint	Embedding Items at Scale: Comparing GNN-Based and ID-Based Item Embeddings in the Yandex Ecosystem Sergei Makeev, Artem Matveev , Vladimir Baikalov, Kirill Khrylchenko

— Teaching

2024 – 2026	Teaching Assistant, Yandex School of Data Analysis (YSDA) DeepRecSys Course . GitHub (140+ stars). ◦ Seminars on evaluation metrics, neural RecSys framework design, neural ranking, and reinforcement learning. ◦ Authored homework assignments for the course.
2025 – 2026	Teaching Assistant, Higher School of Economics Recommender Systems Course . GitHub (90+ stars).
2025	Teaching Assistant, Higher School of Economics Deep Learning Course . GitHub (100+ stars). ◦ Seminar on neural ranking.

— Talks

2025	<i>Do We Need Graph Neural Networks to Encode Items in Recommendations?</i> , Yandex For ML YouTube video .
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— Competitions

2023	Kaggle “ICR — Identifying Age-Related Conditions” Silver Medalist.
2022	ACM ICPC, 2022 ICPC Northern Eurasia Finals Diploma of the 3rd degree.
2020	ACM ICPC, Final of Northern Eurasia 2020 Diploma of the 2nd degree.

— Technical Skills

Languages	Current: Python, Triton, CUDA. Past: C++, Assembly.
Frameworks	PyTorch.
ML Engineering	Full production cycle: data preparation, experimentation, model export & conversion, performance benchmarking, Triton Inference Server deployment, real-time history processing.

— Professional Service

2026	UMAP 2026 — PC member, Industry Track
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— Patents

Dec 2025	Application for invention 2025136959 , Federal Service for Intellectual Property Yandex filed a patent application for Argus (see Scaling Recommender Transformers to One Billion Parameters).
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